

US Civil War

In the early 1860s, the USA, then known as the Union, was torn apart by war. The northern states had made slavery illegal and believed it should be abolished in the rest of the country. The southern states disagreed. Their landowners relied on African slaves to farm their tobacco and cotton. Some southern states felt so strongly, they left the Union.

EVENTS AND BATTLES

Less than a century after gaining its independence, the USA was in danger of breaking up. More than 50 major battles and 5,000 minor ones were fought before the Unionists finally won the war.

1860



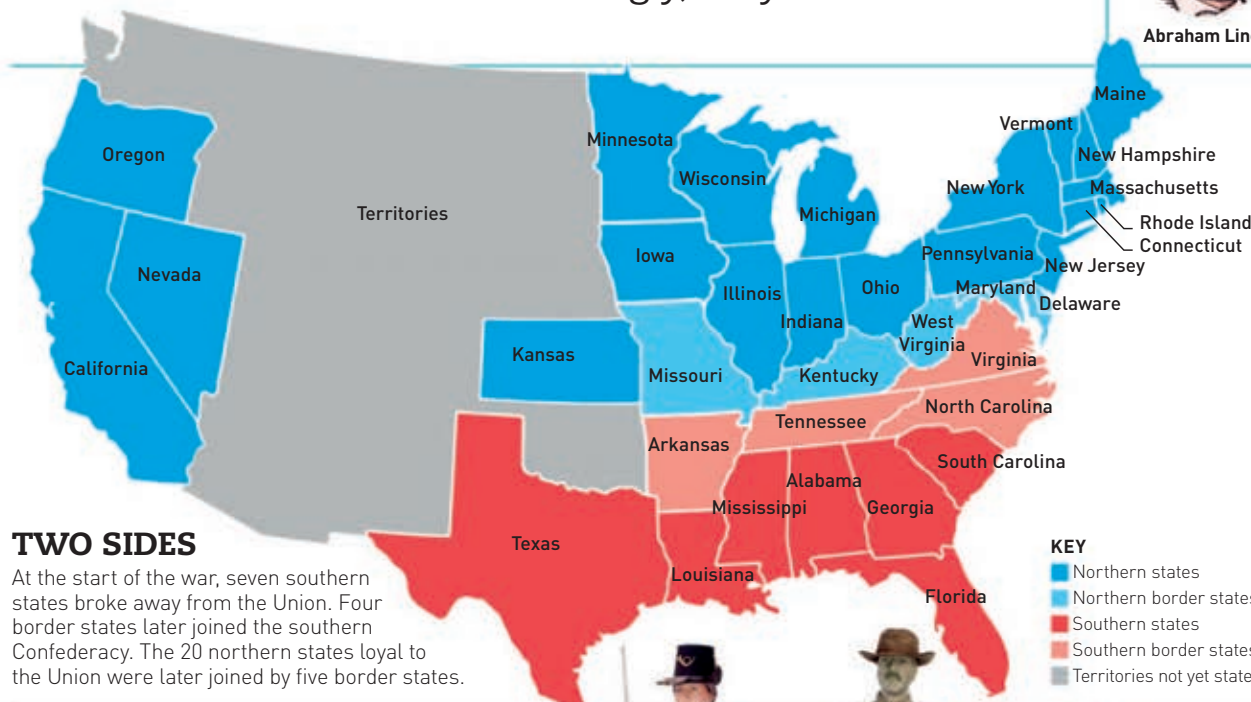
Abraham Lincoln

6 NOVEMBER 1860
Abraham Lincoln is elected the 16th US president. He promises to abolish slavery.

20 DECEMBER 1860
South Carolina withdraws from the Union. Six states follow by February 1861.



Confederate flag



TWO SIDES

At the start of the war, seven southern states broke away from the Union. Four border states later joined the southern Confederacy. The 20 northern states loyal to the Union were later joined by five border states.

UNIFORMS AND KIT

The Union side wore blue and the Confederates, grey. Soldiers carried their food, water, toiletries, ammunition, and personal belongings in a knapsack. Union soldiers were better equipped because the North had more factories to make supplies and railways to transport them.



UNION SOLDIER'S LAP DESK



CANDLE IN TIN



UNION INFANTRY UNIFORM



CONFEDERATE INFANTRY UNIFORM



WATER CANTEEN



TIN MUG



KNIFE



KNIFE AND FORK



KNAPSACK



CARTRIDGE BOX

TRANSPORT INNOVATIONS

The 1830s had seen the birth of the railways. Both sides relied on steam trains to transport troops and supplies, but the North had more than twice as much track as the South. Other advances included the appearance of armoured steam warships, called ironclads, and early submarines.



STEAM LOCOMOTIVE



CSS VIRGINIA (FIRST CONFEDERATE IRONCLAD)



USS MONITOR (FIRST UNION IRONCLAD)

WEAPONS AND CONFLICT

The Civil War was the first in which large numbers of infantrymen were armed with rifles instead of muskets. Rifles shot further, and with greater accuracy. The repeating rifle, introduced in 1863, was even better – it could fire more than one bullet before it needed reloading.



BAYONET FOR SPRINGFIELD 1861



COLT ARMY MODEL 1860 REVOLVER